The Life of Christ

Rules — Ages 8–12 • 2–5 Players • 30–40 Minutes • Moderate

Players	Ages	Time	Difficulty
2–5	**8–12**	**30–40 min**	**Moderate**

> *"I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me." — John 14:6*

About

The Life of Christ is a cooperative journey game. Players travel together through five stages of Christ's earthly life — from His birth in Bethlehem to His glorious Ascension. Along the way, the group draws Event Cards that bring blessings, present trials, and prompt deeper discussion about the Gospel. Work together, manage your shared resources wisely, and journey to the Ascension as one Body in Christ.

> **Formation Goal:** Children experience the life of Christ as a single, connected story — not isolated episodes. They learn that following Jesus requires faith, courage, love, and prayer, and that the Christian journey is walked together, not alone.

Components

- **48 Event Cards** — Blessings, Trials, and Teaching prompts across five stages
- **1 Journey Board** — a path through five stages with resource tracking areas
- **1 Token Sheet** — 48 resource tokens (12 each of Faith, Courage, Love, and Prayer)
- **1 Rules Sheet** — this document
- **1 Leader Guide** — for servants and parents (optional but recommended)

Setup

1. Place the **Journey Board** in the centre of the table.
2. Cut out the **resource tokens** from the token sheet. Sort them into four piles: Faith, Courage, Love, and Prayer.
3. Place **5 tokens of each type** (20 total) in the resource tracking area on the board. This is your starting pool. Return extra tokens to the box as reserves.
4. Separate the 48 Event Cards by stage (check the coloured stage label). Shuffle each stage deck separately.
5. Place the **Stage 1** deck face-down on the board. Keep other stage decks nearby in order.
6. Choose a player to be the **Reader** (reads cards aloud). This role rotates each turn.
7. Place a shared marker (coin or token) on the **Start** space of Stage 1.

How to Play

This is a **cooperative game**. All players form one group and move together through each stage. There are no individual scores — you win or lose as a team.

On Each Turn

1. **Draw** — The Reader draws the top card from the current stage deck and reads it aloud.
2. **Resolve** — Apply the card's effect based on its type:
   - **Blessing** (✦) — Gain the listed resources. Take tokens from the reserve and add them to your shared pool.
   - **Trial** (✘) — Lose the listed resources. Return tokens from your shared pool to the reserve. If you don't have enough of a resource, lose what you can and the group discusses what this trial cost the disciples.
   - **Teaching** (✱) — The group discusses the question on the card. After discussing, the group gains **+1 of any resource** of their choice as a reward for reflecting together.
3. **Advance** — Move your marker one space forward on the journey path.
4. **Pass** — The Reader role passes to the next player clockwise.

Changing Stages

When you draw the last card from a stage deck, you have completed that stage. Before moving to the next stage:

1. Check your resource pool. If **any resource is at zero**, the group must pray together (say a short prayer or a Psalm verse) to receive **+1 of that resource** from the reserve.
2. Place the next stage deck on the board and continue.

Winning the Game

The group **wins** if they reach the Ascension (the final space) with **at least 3 tokens in every resource** (Faith, Courage, Love, and Prayer). You have journeyed through Christ's life together and emerged with a living faith!

The group **loses** if, at any point during Stage 4 (Passion & Cross) or Stage 5 (Resurrection & Ascension), **any resource drops to zero and you have no reserve tokens left** to recover. The trials were too great and the group lost heart.

> **Tip:** The Passion stage is designed to be hard. Resources will drop sharply. Encourage the group to save resources during the Ministry stage and to use Teaching cards wisely. The Resurrection stage brings powerful Blessings — hold on through the darkness!

Tips for a Great Game

- **Read aloud with feeling.** The Reader should bring each card to life. This is storytelling, not just reading.
- **Discuss together.** Teaching cards are the heart of the game. Don't rush them.
- **Younger players:** Let them choose which resources to gain or lose. This builds ownership.
- **Older players:** Challenge them to explain why each event matters for the whole story.
- **Use the Leader Guide** for deeper discussion prompts and Coptic liturgical connections.

Stage Overview

Stage	Colour	Cards	Feel
1. Birth & Childhood	Green	8	Hopeful — blessings outweigh trials
2. Baptism & Temptation	Blue	8	Testing — trials balanced by blessings
3. Ministry & Teaching	Purple	16	Rich — many blessings and teachings to build reserves
4. Passion & Cross	Red	10	Costly — heavy trials, few blessings
5. Resurrection & Ascension	Gold	6	Triumphant — powerful blessings restore all

> *"Let us run with endurance the race that is set before us, looking unto Jesus, the author and finisher of our faith." — Hebrews 12:1–2*

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